

3.3.14 Formatting Tables

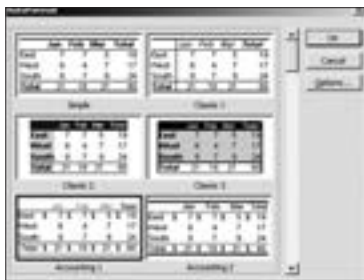
To make it easy to make your data look good, Excel allows you to select from a list of preformatted tables for your data. Once you have entered your data, click anywhere in your table, then select 'Format' from the menu bar, and select the 'AutoFormat' option. This will bring up a menu of preformatted tables. Scroll through the list to find one you like, click to select it, then click 'OK' to create a table for your data.

3.3.15 Using Formulas

Formulas are what do the work in a spreadsheet program. Without formulas, an electronic spreadsheet wouldn't have much of an advantage over a paper version. But with formulas, you can have the spreadsheet program do all your calculations. Formulas take the values of a specified range of cells and perform mathematical operations on them. A formula can add, subtract, divide, multiply, compute averages or interest rates, and perform many other functions.

3.3.15.1 Creating A Formula

Suppose you have a list of various items, and you want to calculate the total number of items. Here, in column A, we have names of various items, and the number of each type of item is listed in column B. We want to find the total of all the items combined, and put that total in cell B6. We also want to change the numbers for each individual item when those numbers change, and we want the spreadsheet to automatically update the total.



A preformatted table in Excel



More preformatted tables!